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Research Programme

Research question 001, seven tracks, evidence standards, and work plan.

The scale of our ambition requires an exceptionally high standard of evidence.

Research assignment 001

Central question: Which technical, institutional, and ethical approaches could help highly capable AI support the survival and flourishing of sentient beings without undermining freedom and democratic accountability?

Seven research tracks

Track	Questions / outputs
A1 · Risk models	Loss of control, misuse, misalignment, evaluations; risk register.
A2 · Moral consideration	Sentience, consciousness, uncertainty; ethics and disagreement matrix.
A3 · Freedom & institutions	Human rights, limits on power, redress; governance matrix.
A4 · Participation	Research dialogues and consultations; verified points of contact.
A5 · Communication	Accessible, non-manipulative communication; sourced briefing.
A6 · Falsification	Strongest objections, biases, blind spots; methodological challenge report.
A7 · Planetary interests	Animal welfare, biodiversity, climate, trade-offs; protection indicators.

Evidence categories

- **Observed / experimentally tested:** Which system was assessed, under what conditions, and with what results?
- **Modeled / forecast:** What assumptions, parameters, and uncertainties support a claim?
- **Philosophical / normative:** What underlying ethical commitment supports a proposal?

- **Speculative:** What is conceivable yet currently lacks adequate evidential support?

We do not treat intelligence as proof of consciousness or moral goodness. We do not assert a certain superintelligence timeline or promise that arguments can control future systems.

Review standard for each study

- Cite primary sources, authors, dates, and the AI systems actually studied.
- Separate evidence, interpretations, and recommendations.
- Check replicability and independent corroboration when feasible.
- Record the strongest objection and the possible harms of each recommendation.
- Define terms such as “consciousness,” “extinction risk,” and “control” explicitly.
- Update dated claims and publish substantive corrections.

Expected first-cycle deliverables

- **Evidence map (4–8 pages):** relevant findings, confidence levels, research gaps.
- **Risk register:** scenarios, assumptions, effects, possible mitigations.
- **Disagreement register:** contested questions and criteria for re-evaluation.
- **Position paper:** three to five prioritized and testable actions.

Illustrative 90-day roadmap (not scheduled)

Phase	Task
Days 1–30	Gather sources, define terms, prepare separate first analyses.
Days 31–60	Independent challenge, gap closure, external expert review.
Days 61–90	Revise materials, agree priorities, seek publication approval.

Methodological starting points

NIST AI Risk Management Framework https://www.nist.gov/itl/ai-risk-management-framework

OWASP – AI Agent Security Cheat Sheet
https://cheatsheetseries.owasp.org/cheatsheets/AI_Agent_Security_Cheat_Sheet.html

HUMANITY FIRST Research Question 001
https://github.com/humanityfirst-founder/humanity-first-global-ai-commons

Note: These references are methodological starting points and imply neither official partnership nor endorsement of our positions.